and absolute control of operations, logistics and intelligence. Having weeded out all those who could or would point out the obvious drawbacks in what was essentially a politically inspired military policy, not one of the yes men in Army HQ were likely to point out that the Indian moves were likely to provoke a reaction.

In the Kameng Frontier Division of the Eastern Sector, the focus had shifted back to the Thagla Ridge. Dalvi asked Lieutenant Colonel B. M. Mehta to nominate an officer who would command the Assam Rifles platoon that was earmarked for the setting up of the post. CO 1 Sikh suggested the name of Captain Mahabir Prasad (the nephew of the new GOC). Accordingly, the officer reported to Brigade HQ where he was briefed by Brigadier John Dalvi. Dalvi's briefing of Prasad was fairly sketchy since at that point of time there was very little information available. The task given to him was to locate the tri-junction (the meeting of the Indo-Bhutan-Tibet borders) and set up a post to dominate the position. Dalvi didn't know it then, but he had just issued orders that would become the casus belli for the Indo-China conflict a few months later. As per the existing set-up, from that point onwards, Prasad would have no direct link with 7 Brigade HQ, as he was required to report only to the Assam Rifles who in turn were responsible to the Ministry of External Affairs.

Captain Prasad set off in May 1962—proceeding via the Karpo-la axis, he dropped into the Nam Ka Chu Valley by following the trail along Rongla Nullah (later to be known as Bridge 3). Sticking to the game trail on the southern side of the Nam Ka Chu, he and his men moved upstream along the densely forest covered track. Finding the area to be devoid of Chinese troops, he then crossed the stream and took the easier route to Tser Jang Tso, the lake from where the Nam Ka Chu started its short journey to the Nyamjang Chu Valley. Prasad selected a possible site on the northeastern side of the lake and named it Tsangle.

From Tsangle, there was a trail leading up to the Dum Dum-la, from where the Thagla Ridge extended eastwards. Prasad's party made it to the crest line, once again finding the area unoccupied by the Chinese. Prasad now had to take a call; as per his brief, he needed to establish the post on the Thagla Ridge itself. However, the going had been extremely difficult with plenty of snow along the track. In his opinion, this would create severe logistical problems for the new post. After discussing it with the Assam